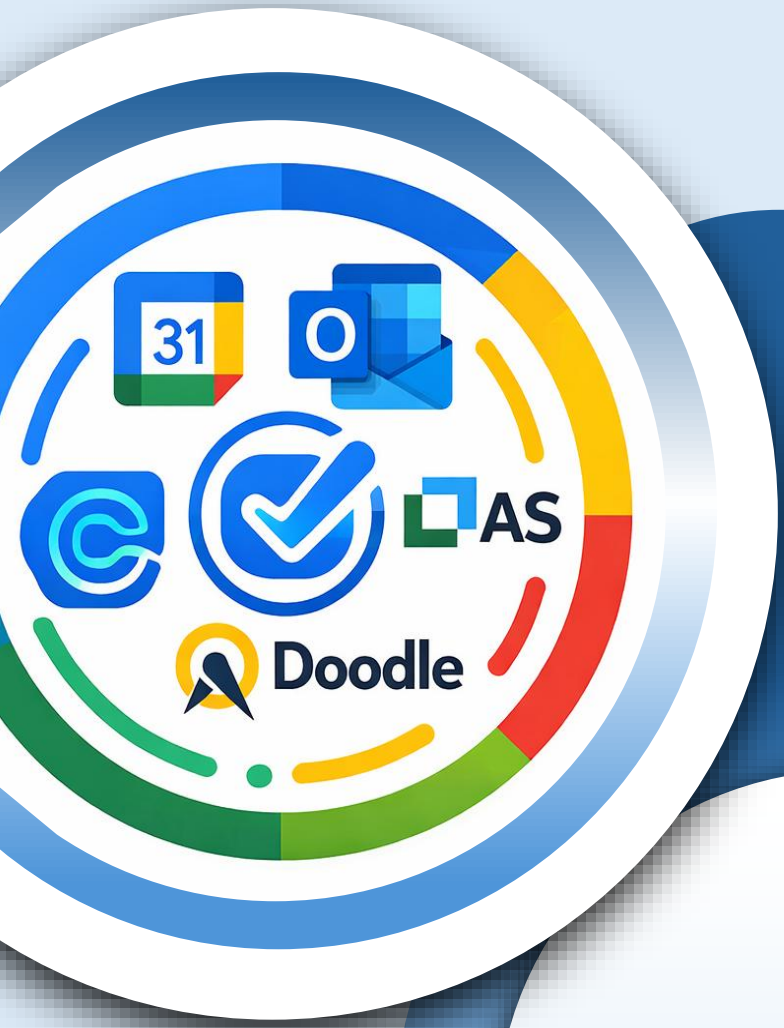
MINDMATRIX

PROFESSIONAL SCHEDULING TOOLS



2026

GOOGLE CALENDAR

Vision Statement

A cloud-based time-management and scheduling tool that serves as the default calendar for millions of professionals worldwide.

Distinctive Attributes

1. Suggested Times: Automatically scans attendees' calendars to find a slot that works for everyone.
2. Appointment Slots: Allows you to create a public booking page where people can reserve specific blocks of your time.
3. Focus Time: A feature that automatically declines meeting invites during designated deep-work blocks.

Competitive Edge

Completely frictionless for Google users; excellent mobile app; integrates natively with Google Meet and Gmail.

Ideal Scenarios

Individuals and teams already using Google Workspace who need a reliable, free, and collaborative daily schedule.

MICROSOFT OUTLOOK CALENDAR

Vision Statement

A robust scheduling platform integrated into the Microsoft 365 suite, combining email, contacts, and tasks into one interface.

Distinctive Attributes

1. **Scheduling Assistant: Provides a detailed grid view of colleagues' availability and conference room status.**
2. **Overlay View: Allows you to stack multiple calendars (e.g., personal, team, and project) on top of each other to identify gaps.**
3. **Board View: A dashboard that displays your calendar, to-do lists, and sticky notes in one visual workspace.**

Competitive Edge

Superior for managing physical resources (like meeting rooms); enterprise-grade security and compliance; offline access capability.

Ideal Scenarios

Large corporations and organizations that rely on the Microsoft ecosystem and manage complex, multi-layered schedules.

CALENDLY

Vision Statement

A specialized "bridge" tool that sits on top of your existing calendar to provide a professional booking interface for others.

Distinctive Attributes

1. **Round Robin: Automatically distributes incoming meetings across a team based on availability or priority.**
2. **Workflows: Automates pre-meeting reminders and post-meeting follow-up emails or texts.**
3. **Routing Forms: Asks invitees questions before they book to ensure they are matched with the right team member.**

Competitive Edge

Drastically reduces administrative overhead; provides a sleek, modern experience for the invitee; prevents double-booking across multiple calendars.

Ideal Scenarios

Sales teams, recruiters, and freelancers who frequently book meetings with external parties.

DOODLE

Vision Statement

A poll-based scheduling tool that allows a host to propose several times and lets participants vote on which ones work best for them.

Distinctive Attributes

1. **Group Polls: A simple visual grid where participants "check" their available slots.**
2. **Hidden Polls: Keeps participant responses private from others to prevent "groupthink."**
3. **Calendar Sync: Automatically adds the finalized time to your primary calendar once the poll is closed.**

Competitive Edge

Solves the "nightmare" of coordinating 5+ people; no account is required for participants to vote; handles time zone differences automatically.

Ideal Scenarios

Board meetings, committee votes, social events, or any scenario where you need to find one time for many people.

ACUITY SCHEDULING

Vision Statement

A high-customization scheduling platform that manages appointments, intake forms, and payments in one flow.

Distinctive Attributes

1. **Custom Intake Forms: Requires clients to fill out information (or upload files) at the time of booking.**
2. **Payment Integration: Seamlessly connects with Stripe, PayPal, or Square to collect deposits or full payments during the booking process.**
3. **Subscriptions & Packages: Allows you to sell "bundles" of sessions or recurring monthly memberships.**

Competitive Edge

Highly professional "white-label" look; automates the entire client onboarding process; robust reporting on revenue and cancellations.

Ideal Scenarios

Coaches, consultants, therapists, and photographers who need to manage client data and payments alongside their schedule.